

UX Collaborator Checkpoint — 2026-03-11

Scope

This checkpoint captures the collaborator-facing UX cleanup, adjacent 3DE control cleanup, and known pre-share hardening gaps as of 2026-03-11.

Implemented

- Collaborators default into shared collections scope.
- The Collections tree is expanded by default for collaborators.
- Collaborators do not see **Other / Non-Home-Design** or **Irrelevant / Discarded** branches.
- Collaborator asset/source browsing excludes effective tracks **irrelevant** and **home_maintenance_diy**.
- **+ New Collection** is owner-only.
- Collaborator-only browse unlock affordances were removed.
- Collaborator modal is question-oriented:
 - shared general notes are read-only/non-writable
 - the prompt to ask a question is promoted above the image
 - collaborator annotations are question-only
 - the annotations/questions section is explicitly labeled
- **Copy ID** sizing bug in the modal was fixed.
- 3DE collaborator controls were reduced:
 - **Looks** is owner-only
 - **Thumbs** toggle is owner-only
- 3DE now uses a short live burst with auto-settle and re-arms on relevant scope/attractor changes.
- Review mode and 3DE are treated as separate workflows.
- Sidebar/source/classification/collections structure was partially reorganized to reduce conceptual mixing.
- **CB**: collections are explicitly treated as AI-derived representative sets, not human-curated sets.

Captured But Not Yet Implemented

- Collections/share product rules established:
 - every collection has explicit intent: **shared** or **working**
 - every shared collection names a collaborator
 - questions are always enabled for shared collections
 - collaborators should not see working collections
 - construction-track collections are working collections for now, not style-side share artifacts
- Dedicated collections/share workflow sprint.
- Collection-scoped share UI, even though **collection_id** links already work at the URL level.

- Collaborator modal header/share redesign.
- Modal next/previous navigation.
- Question flow polish:
 - Enter to submit/close
 - Shift+Enter for newline
 - confirm delete
 - numbering
- Construction-specific UX split.
- Refinement of **Subject Type** enumeration and meaning/value for exploration and understanding.
- Control-panel chip relevance based on current track/scope.
- Scan import hardening for blank separator pages and cleanup of existing artifacts.

Important Operational Gap

The Inspirations server on port 8001 is not yet operationally stable enough for collaborator sharing.

Observed behavior:

- one-shot local `curl` checks can succeed immediately after launch
- the server process can still disappear shortly after
- browser-visible/DevLauncher-visible uptime is therefore not reliable yet

This needs a pre-share hardening pass covering:

- durable local process management
- reliable restart behavior
- crash/shutdown logging
- validation using browser-visible and DevLauncher-visible criteria, not only local `curl` success

Recommended Next Start Point

1. Pre-share hardening for the 8001 server.
2. Dedicated collections/share workflow sprint.
3. Collaborator modal/header/share simplification.
4. **Subject Type** refinement pass for 3DE and taxonomy.